

THE ADVENTURE OF AN AFRICAN KINGDOM

A Dream Adventure Novel

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About the Author

Mohammed Afzal is an aspiring storyteller who finds inspiration in dreams and imagination. This novel is based on a powerful dream that stayed with him for years, eventually becoming the foundation of *The Adventure of an African Kingdom*. Through his writing, he brings fantasy, mystery, and emotion together to create immersive adventure stories.

Table of Contents

Chapter 1: The Dream That Started Everything

Chapter 2: The Kingdom of Black Stone

Chapter 3: The Kingdom's Warning

Chapter 4: The Stranger's Smile

Chapter 5: The Frozen King

Chapter 6: The Awakening of the King

Chapter 7: The Chosen One

Chapter 8: Goodbye to My Old Life

Chapter 9: The Truth of the Kingdom

Chapter 10: The First Encounter

Chapter 11: One Year of Training

Chapter 12: The Final Battle

Final Chapter: The Return

Chapter 1: The Dream That Started Everything

When I was in the 10th standard, I had a dream that felt incredibly real.

It was not an ordinary dream that disappeared from my memory after waking up. Instead, it stayed with me for years, as if it were the beginning of a great adventure waiting to be told.

In my dream, I was a student.

One morning, our school announced an exciting trip. Everyone was curious because none of us knew where we were going. The teachers only smiled and told us to get ready for a journey that we would never forget.

We boarded a large school bus and began travelling through the city.

The atmosphere inside the bus was full of excitement. Some students were singing songs, while others were guessing our destination. I sat near the window, watching the roads pass by and wondering where this mysterious trip would take us.

After a long drive, the bus finally arrived at an airport.

For many of us, it was our first time seeing such a huge airport up close. The sight of aircraft taking off and landing filled us with amazement.

Before entering the airport, we stopped at a small café nearby. We enjoyed snacks and hot tea while discussing our guesses about the destination.

The excitement grew with every passing minute.

Unable to control our curiosity, a few of us approached one of our teachers and asked,

"Sir, where are we going?"

The teacher smiled and replied,

"We are going to Africa."

For a moment, everyone was silent.

Then the entire group burst into excitement.

Africa!

It sounded like a land full of adventure, wildlife, mysteries, and breathtaking landscapes.

I was especially thrilled because it would be my first journey on an airplane. The thought of flying high above the clouds, seeing new countries, and exploring a completely different continent made my heart race with excitement.

As we carried our bags and entered the airport, I felt that this was more than just a school trip.

It felt like the beginning of an unforgettable adventure—one that would change our lives forever.

Chapter 2: The Kingdom of Black Stone

After completing all the airport procedures, we boarded the airplane and began our journey to Africa.

It was my first flight, and I could hardly contain my excitement. As the aircraft rose above the clouds, I looked out of the window and imagined the adventures waiting for us.

Several hours later, we finally arrived in Africa.

The place looked completely different from India. There were no green fields, tall coconut trees, or crowded streets. Instead, vast open lands stretched endlessly in every direction. The ground appeared dry and rugged, and the air felt different. Everything around us seemed unfamiliar, as if we had stepped into another world.

We travelled for many hours across the empty landscape. Along the way, we saw strange rock formations, distant hills, and wide plains that seemed untouched by modern civilization.

As the sun slowly began to set, something enormous appeared on the horizon.

It was a kingdom.

"The African Kingdom."

The kingdom stood proudly among massive black mountains made entirely of dark stone. The mountains surrounded the area like giant guardians protecting an ancient secret. From a distance, the kingdom looked mysterious and powerful.

As we moved closer, we reached a gigantic gate carved directly into a mountain of black rock.

The gate was unlike anything I had ever seen. It was not made of wood or metal. It was made entirely of stone.

With a deep rumbling sound that echoed through the mountains, the gate slowly opened from the ground upward. Dust rose into the air as the ancient entrance revealed a dark passage beyond.

Our group entered cautiously.

Inside, we found another enormous stone gate waiting ahead.

Once everyone had passed through the first gate, it slowly closed behind us with a thunderous crash.

The sound echoed throughout the valley.

Now we were trapped between two giant gates.

Nobody spoke. The excitement that had filled us earlier was slowly being replaced by curiosity and nervousness.

We waited.

One hour passed.

Then two hours.

Finally, after nearly three hours, the second gate began to move. The ground trembled beneath our feet as the ancient stone slowly rose upward.

Beyond the gate lay a hidden world that no one in our group had expected to see.

And that was only the beginning of the secrets of the African Kingdom.

Chapter 3: The Kingdom's Warning

As the second gate slowly opened, we stepped into the hidden kingdom with excitement and curiosity.

Everything around us looked ancient and mysterious. The walls were carved from black stone, and strange symbols covered the rocky surfaces.

While everyone was busy looking around, one of the students from our group walked close to a wall.

Out of curiosity, he touched a small section of the stone.

Suddenly, a piece of the wall cracked and fell to the ground.

The sound echoed through the kingdom.

For a few seconds, everything became silent.

Then, without warning, two soldiers appeared from a nearby passage.

They looked unlike any soldiers we had ever seen before. They were tall and intimidating, wearing heavy metal armor that covered their entire bodies. Their helmets hid their faces, making them look even more frightening.

Behind them was a strange two-wheeled vehicle. At the front of the vehicle, two large dogs were tied with strong chains. The dogs had sharp eyes and stood alert, ready to obey every command.

The soldiers marched directly toward the student who had broken the wall.

Before anyone could react, they grabbed him and placed him onto the vehicle.

One of the soldiers spoke in a deep and powerful voice.

"Anyone who damages any part of the Kingdom of Black Stone will be punished. This kingdom must be respected."

The student tried to explain that it had been an accident, but the soldiers paid no attention.

Within moments, they left, taking him away through one of the narrow stone roads.

We stood frozen with fear.

The excitement we had felt earlier was gone.

Now we understood that this kingdom was not a place where mistakes were easily forgiven.

Nobody dared to touch anything.

After the frightening incident, we realized how hungry we were. We had been travelling for many hours, and our energy was almost gone.

Our teacher gathered everyone together and handed out burgers and drinks.

As we ate, he looked at us seriously.

"Listen carefully," he said. "This kingdom has its own rules. Do not touch anything. Do not wander off alone. Stay together and be very careful."

Everyone nodded.

For the first time since arriving, we felt a sense of danger.

As we finished our meal and prepared to continue deeper into the kingdom, I couldn't stop thinking about the student who had been taken away.

Where had the soldiers taken him?

And what kind of punishment was waiting for him inside the mysterious Kingdom of Black Stone?

Chapter 4: The Stranger's Smile

After finishing our meal, we followed our guides deeper into the Kingdom of Black Stone.

A narrow stone staircase led us underground. The air became cooler as we descended, and the sounds of the outside world slowly disappeared behind us.

The underground passage was unlike anything I had ever seen.

The walls were covered with handmade paintings that seemed centuries old. Some showed great battles between warriors, while others displayed kings sitting on magnificent stone thrones. There were also paintings of strange animals and symbols that none of us could understand.

We walked quietly in a single line, carefully observing everything around us.

As we continued forward, something unexpected happened.

A man suddenly appeared from one of the side corridors.

He was dressed differently from everyone else in the kingdom. His clothes were elegant, decorated with silver patterns, and he carried himself with confidence and authority.

As he passed by our group, he suddenly stopped.

His eyes fixed directly on me.

For a moment, it felt as though he was studying me very carefully.

Then, without saying a single word, he smiled.

Not a friendly smile.

Not a dangerous smile.

It was a mysterious smile, as if he knew something that I didn't.

After a few seconds, he continued walking and disappeared down another corridor.

I stood there confused.

"Why was he looking at me like that?" I asked one of the local guides.

The guide looked surprised.

"You don't know who that was?" he replied.

I shook my head.

"That man is one of the most important people in the kingdom. He is the King's closest advisor, second only to the King himself. Many people call him the Vice Ruler of the Kingdom."

Hearing this made me even more confused.

Why would such an important person stop to look at an ordinary student like me?

And why had he smiled?

The questions remained in my mind as we continued our journey.

Soon, the passage opened into another section of the kingdom, a place that seemed even larger and more mysterious than everything we had seen before.

Little did I know that the strange smile of the King's advisor was only the beginning of a much greater mystery.

Chapter 5: The Frozen King

As we continued our journey, we finally arrived at the main chamber of the Kingdom of Black Stone.

The chamber was enormous.

Rows upon rows of stone seats stretched across the hall. There were at least five long sections of seating, enough for hundreds of people to gather at once. Every chair, pillar, and wall had been carved from the same dark black rock that formed the kingdom itself.

At the front stood a magnificent stage.

In the center of the stage was a giant throne made entirely of stone. It was decorated with carvings of warriors, animals, and mysterious symbols.

According to our guide, this was where the King of the Kingdom would sit whenever he addressed his people.

Everyone in our group was busy looking around the chamber in amazement.

But something else caught my attention.

On the left side of the stage, I noticed a small stone door hidden behind one of the pillars.

Curiosity took control of me.

Without telling anyone, I slowly walked toward it and carefully slipped inside.

The room beyond was silent.

At first, it seemed empty.

Then my eyes widened.

In the center of the room stood a gigantic block of crystal-clear ice.

Inside the ice was a man.

He sat perfectly still in a position similar to a meditation pose, with his legs crossed and his hands resting on his knees.

He was large and heavy, with dark skin and powerful features. Despite being frozen, his presence felt strangely powerful, as if he were still alive.

I could not stop staring.

Who was he?

Why was he trapped inside a block of ice beneath the kingdom?

Suddenly, a loud sound echoed from outside the room.

The noise broke the silence like thunder.

My heart began to race.

Afraid that someone would discover me, I quickly stepped backward and hurried out of the hidden room.

I rushed across the chamber and returned to my friends as if nothing had happened.

Nobody seemed to notice that I had been gone.

But I could not forget what I had seen.

The image of the frozen man remained in my mind.

As I looked toward the King's throne, a frightening thought entered my head.

What if the man trapped inside the ice was not just an ordinary person?

What if he was the real King of the Kingdom of Black Stone?

Chapter 6: The Awakening of the King

Soon after I returned to my friends, several important members of the kingdom walked onto the grand stage.

The crowd quickly became silent.

A meeting was about to begin.

Our teachers guided us to a section of the stone seats, and we sat down among the people of the kingdom. The enormous chamber was packed with citizens, soldiers, and officials.

One of the kingdom's elders stepped forward and began to speak.

"Welcome to the Kingdom of Black Stone," he announced. "This is the greatest and most powerful kingdom in all of Africa."

The crowd applauded proudly.

The elder continued.

"Our kingdom has survived for centuries because of the wisdom of our King. He possesses a rare and extraordinary ability of the mind, a power unlike any other ruler in history."

Everyone listened carefully.

"However," the elder said, "for the last twenty years, our King has remained inside the Sacred Ice Chamber. During this time, the rulers and advisors of the kingdom have carried out the duties of governing and protecting our people."

A wave of whispers spread through the audience.

Even though I already knew about the frozen man hidden inside the chamber, hearing the story from the elder made it seem even more unbelievable.

Twenty years.

Twenty entire years inside a block of ice.

The elder was about to continue speaking when something unexpected happened.

A loud sound echoed through the hall.

Everyone turned toward the stage.

The giant doors behind the throne slowly opened.

At first, nobody could believe what they were seeing.

Then a figure appeared.

The King.

The King of the African Kingdom.

The very same King who had remained frozen inside the Sacred Ice Chamber for twenty years was now walking toward the throne.

The entire chamber fell silent.

Citizens stood up from their seats.

Soldiers looked at one another in disbelief.

Even the kingdom's advisors appeared shocked.

The King walked slowly but confidently. His presence filled the chamber with an energy that was impossible to describe.

For a moment, nobody spoke.

Then excited voices began spreading through the crowd.

"The King has awakened!"

"He has come out of the ice!"

"This has never happened before!"

Even the officials on the stage seemed confused.

One of them whispered,

"If the King has awakened after twenty years, then something important must be happening. This is no ordinary day."

My friends and I stared in amazement.

One of the students sitting beside me smiled and said,

"We came to this kingdom at the perfect time. Out of all the days in twenty years, we are here on the day the King returned."

I nodded silently.

Deep inside, I felt that this was not a coincidence.

The mysterious smile from the King's advisor...

The hidden room...

And now the King's sudden awakening...

Somehow, all these events seemed connected.

And I had a strange feeling that the real story of the Kingdom of Black Stone was only just beginning.

Chapter 7: The Chosen One

The entire chamber remained silent as the King slowly sat upon his massive stone throne.

For a few moments, he simply looked across the crowd.

His eyes seemed calm, yet powerful, as if he could see through every person in the hall.

Finally, he spoke.

His voice was deep and commanding.

"My people," he began, "our kingdom is entering a difficult time. This region faces many challenges, and the future of the Kingdom of Black Stone is uncertain."

The crowd listened carefully.

After a brief pause, the King continued.

"That is why I have awakened today."

Whispers spread throughout the chamber.

The King had not appeared for twenty years, and now everyone wanted to know why.

Then he spoke the words that changed everything.

"I have come to choose the next King of this kingdom."

The crowd gasped.

Even the kingdom's advisors looked surprised.

The students from our group began whispering and joking among themselves.

"Maybe I'll become king!"

"No, I'll be the king!"

Everyone laughed.

After all, we were just students visiting a mysterious kingdom. None of us believed we had anything to do with the King's decision.

Then the King slowly stood up.

He raised his hand.

The entire chamber fell silent.

His eyes moved across the audience.

Then he pointed directly toward someone.

Toward me.

For a moment, I thought he was pointing at somebody standing behind me.

I turned around.

There was no one there.

My heart began to pound.

The King's finger was still pointing at me.

The crowd followed his gaze.

Hundreds of eyes suddenly turned in my direction.

The students stopped laughing.

The teachers stared in disbelief.

The people of the kingdom looked confused.

A heavy silence filled the hall.

Then several royal guards approached me.

"Come with us," one of them said respectfully.

I was too shocked to speak.

The guards escorted me through the crowd and up the steps of the grand stage.

As I stood before the King, I could feel thousands of people watching.

The King looked directly into my eyes.

Then he made an announcement that stunned the entire kingdom.

"This boy shall be the next King of the Kingdom of Black Stone."

The chamber erupted with shock.

People stood up from their seats.

Some shouted in disbelief.

Others simply stared.

My classmates looked completely confused.

My teachers could not understand what was happening.

Even the kingdom's ministers seemed speechless.

And as for me?

I could barely breathe.

I was only a student.

A boy from another country.

A boy studying in the 10th standard.

I knew nothing about ruling a kingdom.

Why had the King chosen me?

How could I become the ruler of the greatest kingdom in Africa?

As the crowd continued to whisper and question the King's decision, only one person remained calm.

The King himself.

It was almost as if he had known this moment would happen for many years.

And somehow, I felt that he knew something about me that nobody else did.

Chapter 8: Goodbye to My Old Life

The entire chamber rose to its feet.

People cheered, clapped, and celebrated as the King slowly removed the royal crown from his head.

He walked toward me and carefully placed it in my hands.

The crown was enormous.

It was made of black metal and decorated with shining stones.

It looked far too large for me.

Then the King helped me sit on the great stone throne.

I could hardly believe what was happening.

The King turned toward the crowd and raised his hand for silence.

"My people," he announced, "I have chosen this boy because he possesses something special. He has a gift that can guide this kingdom toward a better future."

The crowd listened carefully.

"What is this gift?" someone shouted.

The King smiled.

"That is a secret known only to fate."

Whispers spread across the chamber.

Nobody understood what he meant.

Not even I knew what special gift he was talking about.

With trembling hands, I placed the crown on my head.

It was so heavy that I had to hold it with both hands to stop it from falling.

The people laughed kindly, and soon the entire chamber filled with applause.

I smiled nervously.

Inside, however, I was terrified.

I was only a student.

I didn't know how to rule a kingdom.

I wasn't even brave enough to speak in front of a large crowd.

Yet now, thousands of people were calling me their future king.

Soon after the ceremony, an announcement was made.

"Tonight, there shall be a grand celebration for the arrival of our new King!"

The crowd erupted with joy.

Outside the palace, long tables were prepared with food, drinks, fruits, snacks, and fresh juices.

Music filled the air as people danced and celebrated.

My classmates gathered around me, laughing and congratulating me.

Some asked if they could become royal ministers.

Others joked about visiting me in the palace.

For a few hours, everyone forgot their worries and enjoyed the celebration.

But as the sun began to set, a painful reality arrived.

The time had come for my school group to return to India.

The buses were being prepared.

Students were collecting their bags.

Teachers were calling everyone together.

I quickly ran to my teacher.

"Sir," I said, "I'm coming too."

My teacher looked at me with sadness in his eyes.

Then he gently placed his hand on my shoulder.

"No," he replied softly.

I stared at him.

"You are the King of the African Kingdom now."

I couldn't believe what I was hearing.

"You can't come back with us," he continued. "These people need you. This kingdom is your responsibility now."

My heart sank.

I looked at my friends.

I looked at the buses.

I looked at the people preparing to leave.

For the first time since arriving in the kingdom, I felt truly alone.

One by one, my classmates boarded the buses.

Some waved goodbye.

Some smiled.

Others looked just as sad as I felt.

The engines started.

Slowly, the buses began moving away.

I stood there watching until they disappeared into the distance.

The celebration around me continued.

People cheered for their new king.

But I couldn't celebrate.

The life I had always known was leaving without me.

As darkness covered the Kingdom of Black Stone, I stood beneath the stars wearing a crown that felt heavier than ever before.

I was a king.

But for the first time in my life, I was completely alone.

Chapter 9: The Truth of the Kingdom

I slowly walked toward the King, still holding the heavy crown in my hands.

My heart was restless.

Nothing about this moment felt real.

"Sir," I asked hesitantly, "what is happening in this kingdom? Why did you choose me? What am I supposed to do now?"

The King looked at me for a long moment before answering.

His expression turned serious.

"This kingdom is not as peaceful as it appears," he said calmly. "There is a force... a villain who has been disturbing our people for years."

I listened carefully.

"He does not fight like ordinary enemies," the King continued. "His mind works differently. He is intelligent, unpredictable, and extremely dangerous. Many have tried to stop him... but none have succeeded."

I swallowed hard.

"Then why me?" I asked.

The King stepped closer.

"Because I cannot defeat him," he said.

Even I, with all my experience and power, cannot understand his way of thinking."

He paused.

"But you..."

His eyes narrowed slightly.

"You think differently. That is why you were chosen."

I stood silently, unsure whether to feel honored or afraid.

"You must be careful," he added. "This is not a battle of strength. It is a battle of mind."

After that conversation, days slowly passed in the kingdom.

I began learning about the people, their lifestyle, their fears, and their hopes. I walked through the stone streets, spoke with guards, and tried to understand the world I had been thrown into.

Outside the palace, the Kingdom of Black Stone was surprisingly peaceful.

The sky looked endless, and the land carried a quiet beauty that slowly calmed my mind.

But inside me, nothing was peaceful.

Every moment, I missed my school friends.

I remembered the laughter...

The bus journey...

The airport...

And the dream that had brought me here.

Now I was no longer just a student.

I was a king in a foreign land.

And somewhere in this kingdom, a dangerous enemy was waiting—

an enemy that only I was expected to understand and defeat.

Chapter 10: The First Encounter

One day, I was walking through a quieter part of the kingdom, thinking about everything that had been happening since I became king.

The streets were unusually calm.

For a moment, it felt as though the kingdom was at peace.

Then suddenly—

A sharp sound cut through the silence.

An arrow flew through the air.

Before anyone could react, one of the kingdom's men was struck and fell to the ground.

He struggled for his life, gasping and trying to move, while the people around him panicked and ran in different directions.

I froze.

For a moment, I couldn't understand what had just happened.

The peaceful atmosphere vanished instantly.

Fear spread through the streets.

Then, slowly, a man stepped forward.

He walked calmly, as if nothing unusual had occurred.

A strange laugh echoed around him.

"So... you are the new king here?" he said, looking directly at me. "Can you talk to me?"

His tone was mocking.

His presence felt dangerous, as if he had no fear at all.

Anger rose inside me.

I stepped forward and faced him.

"I will defeat you one day," I said firmly. "I challenge you."

For a moment, he stared at me silently.

Then he laughed again.

A loud, cold laugh.

"Let's see," he said.

He turned around without another word and walked away, disappearing into the distance as if he owned the place.

I stood there, my hands shaking with anger.

The wounded man lay on the ground.

The frightened citizens watched in silence.

And for the first time, I came face to face with the enemy I had heard so much about.

That was the moment I understood something clearly.

This was not just a mysterious kingdom.

It was not just a place of ancient secrets.

It was a battlefield.

A battlefield waiting for a war between me and him.

Chapter 11: One Year of Training

The King looked at me with a serious expression after my encounter with the enemy.

"It is not that easy to defeat him," he said firmly. "You will need more than courage. You will need skill, discipline, and control."

I listened carefully, still thinking about the battle and the man's strange laughter.

Then the King continued.

"You must undergo training. Only then will you understand how to survive in this kingdom... and how to defeat him."

From that day forward, my life changed completely.

I was no longer just a visitor or an ordinary student.

I was now being trained as the future protector of the Kingdom of Black Stone.

Every day began early in the morning.

I trained in physical combat, learning how to fight with speed, balance, and strategy.

At first, I struggled even with basic movements.

My body was not used to such intense training.

But I did not give up.

Slowly, day by day, I became stronger.

I also learned mental training—how to stay calm under pressure, how to think quickly in dangerous situations, and how to observe enemies carefully before acting.

The King always reminded me:

"Strength alone is not enough. Your mind is your greatest weapon."

Weeks turned into months.

Months turned into a year.

More than one full year passed since I first arrived in the kingdom.

During this time, I changed completely.

My body became stronger, faster, and more disciplined.

But more importantly, my thinking changed.

I learned how to analyze situations, how to predict danger, and how to stay calm even when fear surrounded me.

Yet, even after all this training, one thought never left my mind.

The villain was still out there.

Waiting.

Watching.

And preparing for something far bigger than before.

My real journey had not yet begun.

Chapter 12: The Final Battle

One day, everything changed.

A large battle broke out outside the kingdom.

Smoke rose in the distance, and the sound of chaos spread across the land. People were dying, and no one fully understood what was happening at first.

Then the truth became clear.

The villain had returned.

He was attacking villages, destroying lives, and spreading fear across the kingdom.

When I saw the destruction, anger filled my heart.

This was no longer just a threat.

It was a war against innocent people.

I immediately gathered the people of the kingdom and called for a meeting.

Standing before them, I spoke firmly.

"Do not be afraid of him. He is strong, but not unstoppable. You have been afraid for too long. If we stand together, united as one kingdom, we can defeat him."

My words slowly reached their hearts.

Fear began to turn into courage.

The people nodded, and for the first time, they were ready to fight back.

The next day, the villain returned.

This time, the entire kingdom stood against him.

He attacked with great power, moving through the battlefield and striking anyone who came near.

But now, the people did not run away.

They stood together behind me.

We had a plan.

Some warriors stayed in the hills, some in the forests, and others in the open battlefield.

The strategy was to surround him from all sides.

Arrows were fired at him from different directions.

But something strange happened.

Not a single arrow hit him.

It was as if he could sense every move before it happened.

Even when surrounded, he stood calmly in the center of the battlefield and laughed.

"You still don't understand," he said coldly.

Then he looked directly at me.

Slowly, he walked toward the center where I stood.

The final fight had begun.

I stepped forward and faced him alone.

Blades clashed, and the ground shook as we fought with full strength.

Every attack I made, he countered with ease.

But I did not give up.

I remembered my training.

I remembered the King's words.

I focused my mind.

Slowly, I began to find openings in his defense.

I struck him with precision, pushing him backward for the first time.

Seeing this, I gave a command to my archers.

"Now!"

A wave of arrows was released at the same time, targeting him from multiple directions.

This time, he was hit.

For a moment, his movements slowed.

I rushed forward, lifted my sword, and struck him down with full force.

He fell to his knees.

For the first time, he was no longer laughing.

The battlefield went silent.

Then, slowly, the people surrounded him.

Together, the kingdom united and ended the battle once and for all.

The villain was finally defeated.

And peace returned to the Kingdom of Black Stone.

Final Chapter: The Return

The Kingdom of Black Stone was finally at peace.

The villages, the people, and the entire kingdom were safe again. The fear that had once ruled their lives had disappeared forever.

Joy returned to the streets.

Celebrations filled the air.

The people cheered loudly for me.

"Long live the King!" they shouted.

For the first time in a long while, I saw smiles everywhere.

The King came forward and placed his hand on my shoulder.

"You have done well," he said with pride. "You brought peace to this kingdom."

I smiled.

But deep inside, I felt something different.

A quiet emptiness.

As if my journey was slowly coming to an end.

Two years passed.

I lived in the kingdom, learned its ways, and grew into my responsibilities.

But one thought never left my heart—
the life I had before all of this.

One day, I went to the King.

"Can I return to my place... my home?" I asked.

The King looked at me for a long moment.

Then he nodded gently.

"You have fulfilled your purpose here. You may return."

I packed my things, wearing the same simple clothes I had arrived in so long ago.

A royal aircraft took me back.

As I flew through the skies, I looked out of the window.

Africa slowly disappeared beneath the clouds.

When I landed, everything felt different.

India looked greener, calmer, and more peaceful than I had ever remembered.

The trees.

The roads.

The air.

Everything felt like home.

A sense of relief filled my heart.

I went back to my school.

The classroom was the same.

The same students.

The same teacher.

The same atmosphere.

I slowly walked inside.

I sat in my old seat.

But something was strange.

No one reacted.

No one looked at me.

No one spoke.

It was as if I had never left.

I tried to speak, but my voice felt distant, almost unreal.

Then I realized something...

Was any of it real?

The kingdom...

The battles...

The crown...

The war...

The King...

Or was it all just a dream?

And then I understood the truth.

I had not returned to reality.

I had only moved from one layer of dream into another.

A dream inside a dream.

Suddenly, my eyes opened.

I was lying in my bed. The morning sunlight filled the room.

My heart was still racing.

Everything—

the kingdom, the crown, the war, the people—

was only a dream.

But even after waking up...

It still felt real.